myCareSignals Privacy Policy

Last updated: 20.01.2026

1. About this policy

This Privacy Policy explains how myCareSignals ("we", "us", "our") collects, uses, stores and shares personal data when care providers use our platform to support children and young people in residential and similar care settings.

Our aim is to be transparent, child-centered and safeguarding-focused on everything we do. This document is written in plain English so that managers, frontline staff and (where appropriate) young people and their families can understand how their information is handled.

This policy applies to the web-based myCareSignals application, related APIs and support services (together, the "Service"). It does not cover third-party websites or systems that you may access from within our Service.

2. Who we are and our role

myCareSignals is a digital record-keeping and therapeutic support platform designed for children's residential homes and similar care settings. The platform is typically used by home managers, keyworkers, therapists and other authorised professionals.

For most data processed in the Service, the care provider (for example, the organisation that runs the children's home) is the Data Controller. myCareSignals acts as a Data Processor, providing the technology and processing personal data only on the documented instructions of the Data Controller, as set out in our contract and this policy.

In some limited cases – for example, where we analyse aggregated usage data to improve system performance or security – we may act as an independent Data Controller. In those situations, we only use information in a way that does not identify individual children or staff wherever possible.

3. What information we collect

The Service is designed to store sensitive information about children and young people in care. The exact data collected will depend on how each care provider uses the platform, but typically includes the following categories:

- Child profile information – initials or name (depending on the provider's preference), date of birth, gender, unique internal ID, placement details and placement history.
- Care context – home name, provider name, local authority or placing agency, keyworker, relevant professionals and agreed plans or targets.
- Therapeutic and wellbeing information – baseline assessments, targets, daily scores, key-working notes, risk indicators, pathway indices, incident summaries and other information relevant to the child's care and emotional wellbeing.
- Safeguarding-related information – concerns, patterns or risk flags recorded by staff in line with the provider's safeguarding procedures, as well as outcomes and actions taken.
- Technical and usage data – IP addresses (in hashed or truncated form where possible), device/browser information, login timestamps, audit logs of who accessed or edited which records and when.
- Support and communication data – messages you send to us for support, feedback on the Service, and records of issues or incidents related to our platform.

4. Special category and children's data

The information stored in myCareSignals will often include health data, information about emotional wellbeing, behaviour, risk and other highly sensitive details about children and young people. Under data protection law this may be classed as special category data and requires additional protection.

We expect care providers to have a clear lawful basis and appropriate safeguards for recording this information in myCareSignals (for example, the child's vital interests, the performance of statutory duties and/or the provision of health or social care). We process such data strictly on the provider's instructions, and we implement strong technical and organisational measures to keep this information secure.

Children's data is never used by myCareSignals for marketing, advertising or any non-care related purposes.

5. How we use personal data

We use personal data stored in the Service only for the following purposes:

- To provide the core functionality of the myCareSignals platform – recording baselines, plans, daily scores, key-working notes, trends and reports so that staff can understand the child's progress over time.
- To support safeguarding and risk management – for example by highlighting patterns that may require follow-up in supervision or multi-agency meetings.

- To ensure the security and integrity of the Service – including logging access, detecting unusual activity and protecting against misuse or unauthorised access.
- To provide customer support and training – for example, helping managers configure homes, resolving technical issues and answering questions about how the platform works.
- To improve and develop myCareSignals – using anonymised or aggregated usage data to identify trends, improve usability and decide which features are most helpful for care providers.
- To meet our legal obligations – such as responding to legitimate requests from regulators or law-enforcement agencies where we are legally required to do so.

6. Legal basis for processing

When we process personal data as a Data Processor, we do so under the lawful bases chosen by the Data Controller (the care provider). These may include the performance of a public task, vital interests of the child, legal obligations or the provision of health or social care.

Where myCareSignals acts as an independent Data Controller for limited purposes (for example, service monitoring and security), we generally rely on our legitimate interests in running a secure and effective service, balanced against the fundamental rights and freedoms of children, young people and staff. We minimise the personal data used for these purposes and anonymise data wherever possible.

7. How long we keep information

We do not decide how long children's care records are retained – this is controlled by the Data Controller in line with statutory requirements and local policies.

Our default approach is to retain data in an active environment for as long as the child's record is open in the Service and then archive or delete it in line with the Data Controller's instructions. Aggregated, anonymised data (for example, general usage metrics) may be kept for longer to help improve and evidence the impact of the platform, but this data cannot be used to identify individual children or staff.

8. Sharing data with others

We do not sell personal data and we do not share it with third parties for marketing purposes.

We may share personal data with the following categories of recipients, strictly as necessary:

- Service providers – such as secure hosting providers, email delivery services and analytics tools, who help us run the platform. These providers are bound by confidentiality and data processing agreements.
- The care provider's authorised users – for example, staff within a children's home, managers, therapists and other professionals who need access under the provider's policies.
- Regulators or law-enforcement agencies – only where we are legally required to do so, or where it is necessary to protect someone's vital interests (for example, serious safeguarding concerns).
- Potential buyers or investors – in the event of a business sale, merger or restructuring, we may share relevant data under strict confidentiality, but any new owner would continue to be bound by this policy and applicable law.

9. International transfers

Our aim is to host and process data within the UK or another jurisdiction approved as providing adequate protection under applicable data protection law.

If we ever need to transfer personal data outside of these jurisdictions, we will ensure that appropriate safeguards are in place – for example, using recognised standard contractual clauses, technical measures such as encryption and strict access controls. Details of any such transfer can be provided to Data Controllers on request.

10. Security of your data

We take the security of children's data extremely seriously. Measures we use include:

- Encryption in transit (using TLS) and at rest for core databases and backups, where supported by the hosting environment.
- Role-based access controls so that users only see the homes and records they are authorised to access.
- Audit logging of key actions (such as logins, record updates and report exports) so providers can monitor how the system is being used.
- Strong password practices and optional multi-factor authentication where supported.
- Regular security updates, monitoring and backup procedures designed to maintain service integrity and availability.
- Internal policies and staff training focused on confidentiality, safeguarding and secure handling of data.

11. Your rights and choices

Because myCareSignals is usually used on behalf of care providers, most data-subject rights requests (such as access, rectification or erasure) should be made directly to the relevant provider or placing authority.

However, if you contact us about a data-protection matter we will support the Data Controller in responding to your request wherever possible. Subject to legal and safeguarding considerations, and acting on the Controller's instructions, individuals may have rights to:

- Access a copy of personal data held about them.
- Request correction of inaccurate or incomplete information.
- Request deletion of data where it is no longer needed and there is no legal basis to keep it.
- Restrict or object to certain types of processing.
- Receive an electronic copy of data in a portable format where applicable.

12. Cookies and similar technologies

The myCareSignals web application uses essential cookies or similar technologies to keep you logged in securely, maintain session state and protect against malicious activity.

We may also use optional analytics tools (for example, privacy-respecting usage analytics) to understand how the system is used and to prioritise improvements. Where required, we will ask for your consent before setting non-essential cookies, and you can manage your preferences via the cookie banner or your browser settings.

For more detail, please see our separate Cookies Policy.

13. Contacting us

If you have questions about this Privacy Policy, or about how myCareSignals handles personal data, you can contact us at:

Email: privacy@mycaresignals.com
(Replace with your actual contact email and registered address when finalising this document.)

14. Changes to this policy

We may update this Privacy Policy from time to time to reflect changes in the law, our services or best practice. When we make significant changes, we will notify care providers and, where appropriate, highlight the changes within the Service.

The latest version of this policy will always be available within the myCareSignals application and can be downloaded as a PDF.